

ECON 1010-05: Introduction to Microeconomics

Tuesday/Thursday 9:30-10:45 am, Norman Mayer 106

Instructor's name: Michael Cobar

Office location: Tilton Hall 201

Office hours: Tuesdays 11am-12pm, Wednesdays 2pm-3pm

- Email me to schedule a time to meet if neither of these times works for you

Email address: mcobar@tulane.edu

- Include ECON 1010 in the subject line when sending me an email

Course description

An introduction to theory of prices and the allocation of resources. Topics include the pricing of goods and services, the determination of wages and returns to capital, market structure, and international trade. Credit Hours: 3

Course Goals

1. Understand Economics jargon in everyday discourse
2. Evaluate decision-making using economic logic

Course Learning Objectives

After completing this course, students will be able to ...

1. Understand and explain key terms in Economics and its underlying logic
2. Illustrate demand and supply curves given underlying consumer and firm behavior
3. Calculate equilibria of demand and supply via price and quantity traded in a market given various market shifts
4. Perform basic welfare analysis of a market given its conditions, demand curve, and supply curve
5. Determine optimal decision-making points for consumers and/or firms given all constraints
6. Compare and contrast firm and consumer outcomes under multiple industry structures of competition

Program-Level Outcomes

Successful completion of this course (and Intro to Macroeconomics) will satisfy needed prerequisites and provide the skills for upper-level Economics courses

Required Student Resources

Microeconomics for Today by Tucker (11th edition) with Cengage MindTap Access

Evaluation Procedures and Grading Criteria

Assessment Types

1. In-Class Assignments
 - a. These will be low-stake assessments within class to gauge learning
2. Cengage/MindTap Aplia Homework Assignments
 - a. These are due before midnight on the next Monday
3. Exams

- a. 2 midterm exams and a final exam
- b. In-class testing consisting of multiple choice and free response questions
- c. The final exam will be cumulative and comprehensive of the same format
- d. **Final Exam Date: Tuesday, December 9th from 12:00-3:00 PM**

Custom Grade Weighting

- i. Students are allowed to choose a custom weight for each assignment type from the ranges listed in the table below
- ii. Weights must be in half-point increments with a total sum of 100%
- iii. Custom grade weight choices **are due on Canvas after receiving midterm exam 1 back (tentatively October 31st)**
- iv. Students will receive the default weights if no custom weight choices are submitted or if their custom weight choices do not satisfy the stated requirements

Assignment Types	Default Weights	Custom Weight Ranges
In-Class Assignments	17.5%	0%-20%
Homework Assignments	17.5%	5%-20%
Midterm Exam 1	20%	17.5%-25%
Midterm Exam 2	20%	17.5%-25%
Final Exam	25%	min 20%

Final Letter Grade Scale

92.5-100 = **A**, 90.0-92.4 = **A-**, 87.5 – 89.9 = **B+**, 82.5 – 87.4 = **B**, 80.0 – 82.4 = **B-**, etc.

Late/Missed Assignment Policies:

1. All in-class assignments must be completed within class at the time assigned and will **not** be accepted late outside of extenuating circumstances
 - a. If you have extenuating circumstances that require you to miss an in-class assignment, then email me as soon as possible with proper documentation and we can determine how to proceed.
2. Homework Assignments are allowed to be submitted **up to 3 days late** with no penalty. After 3 days, it can be submitted for a 10% penalty per day late (not counting the 3-day grace period)
3. If an Exam is missed for any reason, contact me immediately and we will determine the best course of action

Course Schedule

Subject to Change as Needed

Dates	Topic	Reading & Details
8/19-8/21	Introduction; Economic Way of Thinking; Opportunity Costs	Chapter 1, 2.1, 2.2
8/26-8/28	Production Possibilities Model	Chapter 2.3-2.5
9/2-9/4	Market Demand and Supply	Chapter 3.1-3.3

9/9-9/11	Market Demand and Supply; Welfare Analysis	Chapter 3.3-3.4; Appendix 4
9/16-9/18	Market Efficiency	Chapter 4
9/23-9/25	Elasticity	Chapter 5
9/30	Midterm 1	No Class 10/2 (Fall Break)
10/7-10/9	Consumer Theory: Utility	Chapter 6
10/14-10/16	Consumer Theory: Indifference Curves and Budget Constraints	Chapter 6 and Appendix; Custom Grade Weights Due 10/21
10/21-10/23	Producer Theory: Cost Curves	Chapter 7
10/28-10/30	Producer Theory: Short-Run vs Long-Run	Chapter 7
11/4-11/11	Producer Theory: Perfect Competition	Chapter 8
11/13;11/18	Producer Theory: Monopoly	Chapter 9
11/20	Midterm 2	
11/25-11/27	Thanksgiving Break	
12/2-12/4	Producer Theory: Monopolistic Competition	Chapter 10
12/9	Final Exam	12pm-3pm

Attendance Statement

There is no formal class attendance policy; however, students can earn points via in-class assignments. I highly encourage you to come to class as this is the best space to foster learning **as long as** you are respectful of everyone else in the classroom and are not interfering with other students' learning.

AI Statement

Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools can be quite helpful in the learning process. I encourage you to use AI to complement the course resources **only in aiding your learning of the material**. Students are **not permitted** to use any AI tools or platforms to generate, create, complete, or perform any graded assignments (outside of the built-in Cengage MindTap AI). Unauthorized use of AI tools will be considered academic misconduct and subject to disciplinary action.

Code of Academic Conduct

The Code of Academic Conduct applies to all Newcomb-Tulane College students at Tulane University. Students enrolled in the School of Professional Advancement (SoPA) have a separate Code. Tulane University expects and requires behavior compatible with its high standards of scholarship. By accepting admission to the university, a student accepts its regulations (i.e., [Code of Academic Conduct](#), [Code of Student Conduct](#) and [Code of Integrity](#)) and acknowledges the right of the university to take action, including suspension or expulsion, for conduct judged unsatisfactory or disruptive. [School of Professional Advancement Code of Academic conduct](#)

Unless I indicate differently, all exams are to be completed individually and without any study aid, including textbooks, class notes, or online sites. If you have any question about whether a resource is acceptable, you should ask the instructor rather than assume.

Welcoming Community Statement

Your fellow classmates, university students, faculty, and staff represent various backgrounds, perspectives, and experiences. Our classroom is a respectful and welcoming space for everyone committed to learning together. Thus, there will be ***no tolerance for any discriminatory or harassing behavior*** of any kind whether verbal, non-verbal, in-person, or digital. Refer to the expectations set forth in the Tulane University [Student Code of Student Conduct](#) and Tulane's [Antidiscrimination Statement](#).

Recordings Of Class Sessions/Remote Engagement

There will be no recordings of classes unless a student provides the documentation needed for academic accommodation. Classes will be held in-person with no remote access unless I indicate otherwise.

Tutoring

The Academic Learning and Tutoring Center typically offers peer tutoring in ECON 1010. You can schedule a 1:1 tutoring appointment with a peer tutor at the [peer tutoring website](#).

Religious Accommodation Policy

Per Tulane's religious accommodation policy, I will make every reasonable effort to ensure that students are able to observe religious holidays without jeopardizing their ability to fulfill their academic obligations. Excused absences do not relieve the student from the responsibility for any course work required during the period of absence. Students should notify me within the first three weeks of the semester about their intent to observe any holidays that fall on a class day or on the day of the final exam. [See Religious Calendar here](#).

ADA/Accessibility Statement

Tulane University is committed to offering classes that are accessible. If you anticipate or encounter disability-related barriers in a course, please contact the Goldman Center for Student Accessibility to request accommodations. If approved by the Goldman Center, make arrangements with me as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so that they may be implemented in a timely fashion. I will never ask for medical documentation from you to support potential accommodation needs.

Goldman Center contact information: Email: goldman@tulane.edu; Phone (504) 862-8433; Website: accessibility.tulane.edu

Title IX:

Tulane University recognizes the inherent dignity of all individuals and promotes respect for all people. As such, Tulane is committed to providing an environment free of all forms of discrimination including sexual and gender-based discrimination, harassment, and violence like sexual assault, intimate partner violence, and stalking. If you (or someone you know) has experienced or is experiencing these types of behaviors, know that you are not alone. Resources and support are available: you can learn more at allin.tulane.edu.

Disclosures of gender-based discrimination

To comply with the requirements of Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, Tulane University requires all faculty members to report incidents of gender-based discrimination. Please know that if you choose to confide in me, I am required by the university to share your disclosure in a Care Connection to the Office of Case Management and Victim Support Services to be sure you are connected with all the support the university can offer. The Title IX Coordinator is also notified of these disclosures. You choose whether or not you want to meet with these offices. You can also make a disclosure yourself, including an anonymous report, through the form at tulane.edu/concerns.

Statement on Confidentiality and Privacy

Tulane University is committed to protecting the privacy of all individuals involved in a disclosure of gender-based discrimination. Any and all of your communications on these matters will be treated as either “Confidential” or “Private.”

Confidential	Private
Certain individuals and resources (see list below) are designated as confidential. Individuals and resources designated as confidential will not share any information, except in extreme circumstances involving imminent danger to oneself or others, with the Office of Case Management and Victim Services, the Title IX Coordinator, or local law enforcement without the express permission of the disclosing party. ▪ Counseling & Psychiatric Services (CAPS) (504) 314-2277 ▪ The Line (24/7) (504) 264-6074 ▪ Student Health Center (504) 865-5255 ▪ Sexual Aggression Peer Hotline and Education (SAPHE) (504) 654-9543	Private resources means that information related to a disclosure of gender-based discrimination may be shared with key staff members of the University to assist in the review, investigation, or resolution of the disclosure or to deliver resources, accommodations, and support services. Information pertinent to the disclosure will be shared with the following Offices: ▪ Case Management & Victim Support Services (504) 314-2160 or srss@tulane.edu ▪ Tulane University Police (TUPD) Uptown - (504) 865-5911 Downtown – (504) 988-5531 ▪ Title IX Office & Title IX Coordinator (504) 865-5611 or titleix@tulane.edu ▪ Student Affairs Professional On-Call (24/7) (504) 920-9900

Title IX Safeguards for Pregnant and Parenting Students

Title IX also provides reasonable protections and support for pregnant and parenting students. Discrimination on the basis of a student’s pregnancy, childbirth, false pregnancy, termination of pregnancy, or recovery from any of the previous conditions is prohibited by Title IX, and Tulane is committed to providing equal access to academic programs and extracurricular activities to students who might be, are, or have been pregnant. If you need support related to a pregnancy or any of the previously listed conditions, visit pregnancy.tulane.edu for more information, including a list of resources. Student who believe that they may have experienced pregnancy discrimination can file a complaint with the Title IX Office by contacting 504-865-5611 or titleix@tulane.edu, visiting the office in Jones Hall 308, or filing a report at tulane.edu/concerns.

Emergency Preparedness & Response

EMERGENCY NOTIFICATIONS: TU ALERT

In the event of a campus emergency, Tulane University will notify students, faculty, and staff by text message, email, and/or phone call. You are automatically enrolled in this system. Check your contact information annually in Gibson to confirm it is still accurate. Ensure your cell phone number is listed.

TROPICAL/SEVERE WEATHER

Hurricane season begins June 1 and ends November 30 each year.

- Students are required to have a personal evacuation plan that can be implemented independently and without reliance on the university.
- Students should have two plans: one for evacuation and one for shelter in place. When planning to evacuate, you should plan to be gone at least a week.
- Visit emergencyprep.tulane.edu/hurricane-preparedness for more information.

Monitor the weather and Tulane communications.

- During hurricane season check the weather regularly and watch your Tulane email for university communications.
- Monitor the Tulane emergency website (tulane.edu/emergency) for university-wide announcements relating to tropical storms and hurricanes.

If severe weather strikes while you are on campus:

- Follow instructions in all TU Alerts.
- Seek shelter indoors until the severe weather threat has passed and the TU Alert All Clear message is sent.
- Do not use elevators.
- Do not attempt to travel outside if weather is severe.

In the case of a university evacuation:

- Activate your personal evacuation plan.
- Classes may be moved online or postponed; look for announcements from your professors in Canvas.
- Take all materials you will need to attend classes remotely with you when you evacuate.
- If you evacuate before the university has cancelled classes OR if the university is sheltering in place, it is your responsibility to communicate with your professor.

ACTIVE SHOOTER/VIOLENT ATTACKER

EVERBRIDGE APP

- **RUN** – run away from or avoid the affected area, if possible.
- **HIDE** – go into the nearest room that can be locked, turn out the lights, and remain hidden until the TU Alert All Clear message is sent.
- **FIGHT** – do not attempt this option except as a last resort.

- Download the Everbridge app from the App Store or Google Play store.
- The Report feature allows you to silently and discreetly communicate with TUPD dispatchers.
- The SOS button allows you to notify TUPD if you need help.

- For more information or to schedule a training, visit emergencyprep.tulane.edu.

- The Safe Corridor button serves as a virtual escort and allows you to send check-in notifications to TUPD.